



HER NEXT GOAL IS TO EARN INDIA A 2026 WINTER OLYMPICS QUOTA SPOT AT SEPTEMBER'S BEIJING QUALIFIER



Bright start: Tara made her Winter Asian Games debut in Harbin, China, this year. She finished a creditable eighth out of 24 finalists. AFP

'Best we've ever had'

A three-time national champion, Tara has witnessed a positive change first-hand during her trips to Gurugram's Ambience Mall for the nationals.

"A few years ago, when I'd walk in with my skates, the mall security had no idea why I was there. Now they know, and are like 'Okay, you're going to the rink,'" she smiles.

While Tara clinched two silver medals last year at international tournaments in Iceland and Slovenia, her journey is far from complete. There's still much left for her to achieve. Former figure skater Ami Parekh once represented India at the World Championships twice — a benchmark Tara now hopes to surpass.

Yet, the secretary of the Ice Skating Association of India, Jagraj Singh Sahney, calls her "the best we've ever had". "The quality of her jumps and turns makes her untouchable."

Tara's next big target: securing India a quota spot for the 2026 Winter Olympics. The final chance will come at a qualifying event in Beijing this September. While she doesn't make promises of creating history, Tara remains committed to the sport. "Whatever happens in this qualification, I will definitely continue skating. I have personal goals that don't necessarily depend on the Olympics. There's so much more I want to explore."

Those personal goals include delving deeper into the artistic side of skating — the part she enjoys most. As Tara continues to scale a new peak nearly every week, she dreams of conquering the greatest one yet: becoming the first Indian figure skater to compete at the Winter Games.